

Deciding whether Bluefin is a Chicago buyer

Account entry plan for Spencer Refer | Prepared Thursday, October 1, 2026 | Sources: HubSpot, Lemlist, ZoomInfo, Apollo

1 contact in the sequence	~55 employees, down ~12% in a year	New York HQ (41 Madison Ave)	1 partner living on Chicago's North Shore
STAGE Wave B prospect. No deal.	RUNNING NOW CTF ABM - Bluefin Trading (Wave B), 1 lead	LAST TOUCH Sep 23: email 2 to Rick Noltemy	NEXT STEP Mon Oct 5: one qualifying email to Rick Noltemy

Bottom line

Bluefin Capital Management is a **New York** trading firm of about 55 people, and it is shrinking (down about 12% in a year). HubSpot lists it as Chicago, but Apollo puts its headquarters at 41 Madison Ave. The only technology decision-maker is **Rick Noltemy, Director of Technology**, based in New Jersey, who has had two emails and no reply. There is one Chicago thread: partner **Art Duquette** lives in Kenilworth, IL. This account needs qualifying, not a campaign: one direct question to Noltemy about whether Bluefin runs anything in Chicago, then keep or drop it.

Why this account is different

This is a fishing spot you haven't confirmed has fish. Before buying more bait, drop one line: ask whether Bluefin has racks or circuits in Chicago. If the answer is no, move the effort to accounts that do.

Signals worth citing

Signal	Source	So what for the opener
No Bluefin Capital signals; ZoomInfo matched bfc.com to a different company (Bluefin Payment Systems, Atlanta)	ZoomInfo	No trigger to cite. Fix the ZoomInfo match before the next scouting run.
Headcount down ~12.5% over 12 months, ~55 employees	Apollo	Cost-sensitive. Only a clear Chicago need will justify spend.
Rick Noltemy, Director of Technology since 2011; previously US CTO at Van der Moolen (an options market maker)	Apollo	Knows listed-options infrastructure, which is Chicago-centric.
Partner Art Duquette lives in Kenilworth, IL	Apollo	Possible Chicago trading desk. Ask, don't assume.

Check first

HubSpot shows Bluefin in Chicago; Apollo shows New York. A Lemlist lead from 'Bluefin Payment Systems' was deleted from this campaign on Sep 9, so the lists were mixed up once already. Confirm the account's location before the Salesforce upload.

Work already in motion

When	Channel / campaign	What happened	Read
Sep 9	Wave B setup	A 'Bluefin Payment Systems' lead was deleted from the campaign	List mix-up caught
Sep 11-14	Wave B, visit + email 1	To Rick Noltemy	No reply
Sep 16-21	Wave B, LinkedIn invite + follow	To Rick Noltemy	Not accepted
Sep 23	Wave B, email 2	'The part of your path map you can't see'	No reply

Who to reach, in order

Contact	Title (source)	Where	Why they matter	Status / email
Rick Noltemy	Director of Technology since 2011 (HubSpot, Apollo). Ex-US CTO, Van der Moolen.	Morristown, NJ	The only technology decision-maker.	Wave B, no reply. rnoltemy@bfc.com (verified)
Mayank Saraswat	Senior Systems Engineer (Apollo). Ex-network operations engineer.	New York	Hands-on; knows where servers live.	Not contacted. msaraswat@bfc.com (verified)
Art Duquette	Partner (Apollo)	Kenilworth, IL	Chicago-based partner. Use only to confirm a Chicago desk exists.	Not contacted. aduquette@bfc.com (verified)

Not worth chasing for this goal

Traders, portfolio managers, the CFO and compliance are not network buyers.

How the access path should run



Messages, by contact

1. Rick Noltemy Director of Technology

Why them: A yes/no question he can answer in five seconds.

Channel: Email reply in the Wave B thread, Mon Oct 5 | Subject: Re: the part of your path map you can't see

Rick, I'll keep this short. Does Bluefin run any servers or circuits in Chicago today, for the options markets or otherwise? If not, I'll stop writing. If yes, I own underground fiber there and would like 15 minutes.

2. Mayank Saraswat Senior Systems Engineer

Why them: Fallback if Rick doesn't answer.

Channel: Email, Tue Oct 13 | Subject: Quick question on Chicago

Mayank, quick one: does Bluefin host anything in Chicago data centers? I own fiber there and want to know whether it's worth a conversation with your team.

The plan

When	Move	Notes
Thu Oct 1	Fix the ZoomInfo company match (Bluefin Capital, not Bluefin Payment Systems) and confirm HQ location in HubSpot.	Data hygiene.
Mon Oct 5	Qualifying email to Rick Noltemy.	-
Tue Oct 13	If no reply, email Mayank Saraswat.	-
Mon Oct 19	Decide: keep in nurture (Chicago footprint confirmed) or downgrade from Wave B.	Report the outcome to management either way.

What progress looks like (for management)

By	Milestone	How we will know
Oct 19	Know whether Bluefin has a Chicago footprint	HubSpot note and tier updated

Guardrails

- Don't spend more sequence steps until the account is qualified.
- Credits used: 4 Apollo person enrichments.

Sources

HubSpot company and contact records; Lemlist 'CTF ABM - Bluefin Trading (Wave B)' activity and HubSpot note (Sep 9 lead deletion); ZoomInfo company match (mismatched); Apollo people and organization data (Oct 1, 2026).